



Maya and the Brave School Secret

By Or and Shiraz Shterenshus



Today was a very big day for Maya. It was her first day at a brand-new school! Her backpack was bright yellow, just like Loki's favorite ball. Loki sat by the door, his tall ears pointing straight up as he watched Maya get ready.



Maya felt a little bit nervous. Her tummy felt funny, just like Loki's tummy did when he heard a new voice. Loki nudged her hand with his cold, wet nose. He was being brave for her, so Maya took a deep breath and gave him a big hug.





The new school, Starbright Elementary, looked like a giant castle. It had tall windows and a wide wooden door. Maya stood at the gate, holding her backpack straps tight. The playground was full of new children running and shouting.





A teacher named Mrs. Quill walked out to the steps. She had a very kind smile and a twinkle in her eye.

"Welcome, Maya!" she said in a voice as soft as a song. Mrs. Quill held the door open wide, inviting Maya into the magic inside.





Inside, the classroom was very big and a little bit loud. There were colorful drawings on every wall and toys in every corner. Maya felt very small. She looked around for a place that felt safe and quiet, just like Loki does at home.





In the corner of the room,
Maya spotted something
wonderful. It was a big,
puffy blue armchair, just like
the one Loki hides behind!
Maya sat down in the soft
chair and opened a book.
She felt much better in her
cozy spot.





Suddenly, a boy named Leo walked over. Leo was very quiet and stayed very still. He didn't shout or run. He just stood by the blue chair, holding a small wooden airplane in his hand. Maya looked up from her book and smiled.





Leo sat on the rug next to Maya. He didn't say much, but he showed her how his airplane could zoom through the air. Maya realized that Leo was a little bit shy, too. She reached into her bag and showed him a drawing of Loki.





When Maya got home, Loki was waiting at the door, wagging his tail fast. Maya knelt down and petted his soft back. "I was brave today, Loki!" she whispered. Loki licked her cheek, knowing that they were both very brave indeed.

